

DECISIONS_LOG - matts-timer-app

Fable's record: Matt's decisions in his words, and Fable's review and sign-off of each Opus build. Newest at the bottom.

2026-09-20 - Repo flipped to Fable-main

Matt's words, in this repo's chat: "Flip it and I will tell you what I want added. It is all local, no internet, no syncing with other apps, etc... still a simple timer but I need it to work correctly on my phone and that is where you come in Fable. Build the subagents and workflow rules. Let me know when you're done and I'll start a new session for the feature adds"

Done by Fable the same day, at commit 4cbb214 as the starting tree:

- `CLAUDE.md` written (Sections 1-4), modelled on `matts-doc-reader` and `matts-calendar-app`, both flipped 2026-09-18.
- `.claude/agents/opus.md` written (model opus, effort high). No `opus-xhigh`: no global rule 3 `xhigh` class exists in this repo. No `fable-*` files: Fable does not spawn Fable in a flipped repo.
- `docs/handoff/FOR_FABLE.md`, `FOR_FABLE_LOG.md`, `NEXT_CHAT_2026-09-20.md` and this log created.
- `tools/md2pdf.py` copied in from `matts-doc-reader` (read there, written here) so every `.md` has its PDF.

Open from this entry: the Fable-owned list in `CLAUDE.md` Section 1 is Fable's proposal and is NOT accepted by Matt yet (`FOR_FABLE.md` item 1).

Walls recorded from his words: no INTERNET, no syncing with other apps, "still a simple timer". Measured the same day: the manifest's only permission is `VIBRATE`; `dependencies { }` is empty; release is signed with the debug key; no tests exist; `adb devices` listed no device (n=1).

2026-09-20 - v2 build: Fable review of f0071a1 - SIGNED for phone check

Job: Matt's four adds (his words and answers in `docs/handoff/FOR_FABLE.md` item 1). Spec by Fable, built by Opus at f0071a1 on base 32f83ed.

Reviewed line by line against the spec [measured, n=1 read]: `TimerEngine.kt` (492 lines) and `TimerService.kt` (212 lines), the manifest diff, and the Activity's wiring by grep.

- Clock math moved unchanged: `endsAt = now + remainMs`, `pause remainMs = (endsAt - now) >= 0`, `swBase = now - swElapsed`, all `elapsedRealtime`.
- The finish is decided only in `finishCue()` (guarded on running, cue generation counter, re-posts if the clock still shows time). The Activity never calls `timerFinish`.
- Audio focus: `GAIN_TRANSIENT_MAY_DUCK`, requested before the 3 s tick (or at start inside the last 3 s), only when sound is on; abandoned in `RESTART`, `RESET`, `PAUSE`, preset select; held through `TIME`. No stream volume write anywhere (grep: no matches, also none for `AlarmManager` or `INTERNET`).
- Service: not exported, not bound, `specialUse`, `startForeground` first in `onStartCommand`, `onTaskRemoved` does nothing, `START_STICKY` restore through prefs. Partial wake lock only while the countdown runs (remaining + 10 s timeout) and 6 s past the finish.

- Manifest: only the <service> element added by Opus; the five permission lines are Fable's from 32f83ed. dependencies { } empty.
- Opus's ten stated deviations read and accepted (tap target is the digits block; SET & START dimmed-not-disabled at 0:00 so a typed value can commit; restore gated on the boot offset for all state; stopwatch START also triggers the one-time notification ask).
- Build: assembleRelease passes on the committed tree, APK 674,357 bytes [measured, n=1]. dist/MattsTimer.apk NOT replaced yet.

Follow-ups seen, not fixed: (a) a process restored with under 3 s left does not re-request the duck; (b) pause at the last instant can leave "paused 0:00" where START refuses (in v1 too); (c) a process killed and reopened hours later in the same boot shows TIME for the old set.

Everything on-phone is [verify, n=0]: lock-screen display, finish with the screen off, swipe from recents, Spotify ducking. Not DONE until the phone check passes. Matt, 2026-09-20: "I have another session working on my phone so don't interrupt it. Trust the serial is correct. Once that session is done you can ask me for permission to build and test on my phone." No adb from this session until he says that session is done.

2026-09-20 - Rising repeat chime: Fable review of f3d3ed5 - SIGNED for phone check

Matt's words: "one more feature while you are waiting. Can you gradually increase the timer volume once it has expired". Fable asked three questions with recommendations (repeat until he taps; 30 percent to full by the 5th chime, auto-stop at 2 minutes; ramp the app's own sound only, never a volume slider). His answer: "thats fine build it in". Spec by Fable, built by Opus at f3d3ed5 on base 570fa71.

Code diff read line by line [measured, n=1 read] (TimerEngine.kt, TimerService.kt, Tones.kt):

- Tones.play(pcm, gain = 1f) sets the AudioTrack's own volume; synthesis untouched; no stream volume write (grep: no matches, none for AlarmManager or INTERNET either).
- Gains 0.30, 0.475, 0.65, 0.825, 1.0 then 1.0; period = chime length + 1000 ms; buzz with every chime; sound, voice and vibe read at each fire.
- One cue at a time through postCue; alarming cleared only in clearCues(), which RESTART, RESET, preset select and SET & START all reach. timerFinish clears first, then sets alarming.
- No chime starts later than 120 s after the finish, measured on elapsedTime. Accepted deviation: alarming is held until the last chime has rung out (about 124 s worst case) so the wake lock is not dropped mid-tone; the lock's own timeout is 130 s.
- A restored finished state does not ring.
- Build: assembleRelease passes on the committed tree [measured, n=1].

Seen, not fixed: starting the stopwatch or switching tabs does not stop the ring-out; the red flash outlives the 2-minute audio stop; the screen may sleep during the ring-out (the chimes do not depend on it).

On-phone behavior [verify, n=0]. Joins the v2 phone check, still waiting on Matt's word that the other phone session is done.